

Dutch Bros Inc.

 3 June 2026

 Verify before use

 COMPANY SNAPSHOT

1 REVENUE & MARGIN

Dutch Bros Inc.'s last reported annual revenue for fiscal year 2025 was \$1.64 billion. The net margin for fiscal year 2025 was 4.9%. Operating margin for 2025 is not publicly available.

2 REVENUE TREND

Revenue and Net Margin for the last 5 years:

Year	Revenue (Billion USD)	Net Income (Million USD)	Net Margin (%)
2025	\$1.64	\$79.8	4.9
2024	\$1.28	\$35.3	2.8
2023	\$0.966	\$1.718	0.18
2022	\$0.739	\$(4.753)	(0.64)
2021	\$0.497	\$(12.679)	(2.55)

3 EMPLOYEES

Total global headcount was 32,000 as of December UNVERIFIED 31, 2025. A detailed breakdown by high-cost locations (US, UK, Germany, Australia, Canada) for the total global headcount is not publicly available.

4 INDIA PRESENCE

Dutch Bros Inc. has a presence of 1 employee in India UNVERIFIED. There is no publicly available information indicating an India Global Capability Center (GCC), delivery center, or R&D center with a significant headcount or specific location details beyond this individual.

5 RECENT NEWS

(a) Product News

May 1, 2026: Dutch Bros® launched the new Myst Energy Refresher™ and brought back seasonal favorites.

February 27, 2026: Dutch Bros® released a new drink trio.

February 10, 2026: Dutch Bros® expanded its CPG (Consumer Packaged Goods) product line for at-home consumption, now available more broadly through Amazon and select grocery and retail partners. The collection includes signature ground coffee, ready-to-drink iced lattes, creamers, and single-serve coffee pods in flavors like Golden Eagle® and Annihilator®.

February 1, 2026: Dutch Bros® launched decadent drinks to celebrate Dutch Luv®.

(b) Company News

May 26, 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. announced its participation in an upcoming investor conference.

May 13, 2026: Dutch Bros® opened its first shop in Melrose Park, Chicagoland.

May 12, 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. announced an agreement to acquire a Phoenix East Valley franchise comprising 29 shops from a retiring franchise owner.

May 11, 2026: Dutch Bros® held its annual "Drink One For Dane®" day of giving to raise ALS awareness.

May 6, 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. reported its first-quarter 2026 financial results.

February 12, 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. reported its fourth-quarter and fiscal year 2025 financial results.

January 5, 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. appointed Jennifer Somers as Chief Shops Officer.

6

M&A ACTIVITY

May 2026: Dutch Bros Inc. agreed to acquire a Phoenix East Valley franchise consisting of 29 shops.

January 2026: Dutch Bros acquired Clutch Coffee Bar, a regional drive-through coffee chain with 20 locations across North and South Carolina. These locations are being converted to the Dutch Bros brand.

7

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

Dutch Bros Inc. is a publicly traded company on the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) under the ticker symbol BROS. Its ownership is a mix of institutional, retail, and individual investors, with no single company or person holding a majority stake. TSG Consumer Partners holds approximately 30% of the total equity. Travis Boersma, a co-founder and Executive Chairman, remains on the board but has sold most of his shares.

8

KEY COMPETITORS

Top competitors include:

Starbucks

Dunkin'

7 Brew Coffee

Scooter's Coffee

Caribou Coffee

GAP FILL

Dutch Bros' operating margin for 2025 was reported as 8.28% at the end of the year. Other sources indicate an operating margin of 9.3% for 2025, and 9.84% (or 9.8%) for FY2025.

GAP FILL

Dutch Bros does not publicly provide a detailed employee breakdown by specific departments with associated numbers or percentages. While various departments like Human Resources, Marketing, Engineering, Retail, Operations, and IT are known to exist within the company, the number of employees within each of these departments is not disclosed in the available information.

SOURCES (36)

companiesmarketcap.com simplywall.st wikipedia.org macrotrends.net q4cdn.com macrotrends.net stockanalysis.com
 leadiq.com seekingalpha.com dutchbros.com dutchbros.com prnewswire.com stocktitan.net dutchbros.com
 investing.com dutchbros.com seekingalpha.com marketlog.com dutchbros.com nasdaq.com tastingtable.com
 kraken.com tipranks.com businessmodelcanvastemplate.com owler.com marketbeat.com businessmodelcanvastemplate.com
 owler.com zippia.com companiesmarketcap.com gurufocus.com options.cafe leadiq.com dutchbros.com
 dutchbros.com dutchbros.com

STRATEGIC DIRECTION

1. CORPORATE VISION & DIRECTION

Dutch Bros Inc. is aggressively focused on nationwide expansion and strengthening its brand through enhanced customer engagement and operational efficiency. CEO Christine Barone articulated this vision, stating, "We believe our brand is resonating with customers, as we delivered 2.3 per cent system same shop transaction growth, the largest year-over-year increase in over two years. Our efforts to develop our foundational transaction drivers – innovation, paid media and our Dutch Rewards loyalty program – are working. We believe these efforts are contributing to current momentum and that there is considerable runway for further growth." The company aims to reach 2,029 shops by 2029, a near doubling of its footprint, with a long-term potential of over 7,000 locations nationwide.

This growth is underpinned by a strategy to accelerate geographic expansion, optimize unit economics, and deepen digital engagement. Barone emphasizes that "All of our growth is predicated on people."

For the next 12-18 months, leadership is committed to sustained expansion, with plans to open "at least" 160 locations in 2025, representing a 16% system growth. The company is refining its real estate strategy to focus on a wider net in new markets, allowing more time to build brand awareness and customer habits. There's also a strategic shift towards a greater mix of build-to-suit leases to manage costs, expected to take hold in 2025. Dutch Bros also intends to optimize its morning daypart sales, which currently lag the industry average, by expanding its food program.

2. BIG STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

Aggressive Expansion & "Fortress Strategy": Dutch Bros is executing an aggressive expansion plan, targeting at least 160 new shops in 2025. The company opened 159 net new stores in 2024 and reached its 1,000th outpost in February 2025. This expansion is increasingly focused on company-operated stores to maintain quality and margins, particularly in markets like Texas, Florida, and Arizona, as part of a "fortressing" strategy to increase brand visibility and market share through concentrated openings. The company has set a goal of 2,029 shops by 2029 and sees a total addressable market of over 7,000 shops in the U.S. Brian Cahoe was appointed Chief Development Officer in February 2025 to oversee this expansion.

Product Diversification & Innovation: Beyond coffee, the "Rebel" energy drink line accounts for approximately 25% of sales, and management is expanding seasonal and sugar-free options to capture more "anytime" consumption occasions and increase average ticket values. The company also plans to introduce an expanded food program, currently piloted in 32 shops, with a nationwide rollout anticipated by the end of 2026, aiming to increase morning sales. Dutch Bros will also enter the consumer packaged goods market in partnership with Trilliant Food & Nutrition, launching a line of packaged coffee to build brand awareness, especially in newer markets.

Supply Chain & Infrastructure: The 2024 Daybreak, Utah, roasting facility is a strategic infrastructure milestone, supporting up to approximately 3,000 shops and underpinning eastward growth while ensuring beverage consistency and delivery speed.

Cost Transformation & Capital Efficiency: Dutch Bros is focused on optimizing unit economics. The average capital expenditure per shop declined by approximately 15% to \$1.4 million in Q2 2025, with a long-term target of \$1.25 million, partly due to a transition towards build-to-suit lease arrangements. The company also refinanced its credit facility in Q2 2025, establishing \$650 million in capacity to support expansion and manage working capital.

Sustainability Mandates & Philanthropy: Dutch Bros' commitment to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is evident in its focus on sustainable sourcing of coffee beans, partnering with growers practicing environmentally friendly methods, and achieving 100% Responsibly Sourced Coffee per the Enveritas Standard. The Dutch Bros Foundation supports health programs in coffee origin countries like Colombia, focusing on sustainable farming practices and healthy lifestyles. The foundation also focuses on youth, health, and origins, supporting company-wide and local giveback days. The company has also initiated shop-level recycling and composting programs, negotiated 100% renewable energy through RECs, and is testing energy efficiency initiatives in shops.

3. TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY

Dutch Bros is actively investing in and leveraging technology to enhance efficiency, customer engagement, and growth.

AI Adoption Stance: Dutch Bros has invested in AI-driven platforms to optimize efficiency and growth. The company is also testing artificial intelligence technology to increase drive-thru throughput. However, any technology implementation must benefit the employee and customer experience.

Cloud Migration & Platform Consolidation: Dutch Bros has invested in cloud applications. In 2020, the company deployed Xenial RTIconnect as a cloud-based Restaurant Management solution across approximately 400 U.S. drive-thru locations, executing a front-of-house POS and operations modernization. This cloud-based system integrates with other internal systems, providing valuable insights and streamlining drive-thru service.

Digital Engagement & Loyalty: The Dutch Rewards loyalty program is a key strategic driver, with a significant percentage of transactions (66% in Q1 2024, 73% at the end of 2025) coming from members. The Dutch Bros app plays a central role, allowing customers to explore menus, customize drinks, and order in advance, acting as a "discovery engine" to encourage experimentation and repeat visits. Mobile ordering and pay were launched nationwide in Q4 2024, accounting for 11% of transactions in Q1 2025, and are expected to further bolster the morning daypart.

Vendor Relationships & Build vs. Buy Signals: Dutch Bros collaborates with technology vendors such as Oracle, BambooHR, and Global Payments for cloud applications and AI-driven platforms. They have also adopted applications like Rocket.chat, Algolia Search, and Braze Platform. The selection of Xenial for their POS system was driven by the need for an enterprise-ready solution that could integrate with other systems and provide business insights, indicating a "buy" approach for core platforms while focusing on integration and operational excellence.

 SOURCES (24)

- uk.com restaurantdive.com shoppingcenterbusiness.com businesswire.com investing.com
- businessmodelcanvastemplate.com nrn.com fool.com convenience.org monexa.ai tickertrends.io kavout.com
- tradingview.com prezi.com lindseynewkirk.com dutchbros.com dutchbros.com dutchbros.com appsruntheworld.com
- nrn.com xenial.com forbes.com retailnews.ai businesswire.com

 LEADERSHIP & ORG

1

KEY DECISION MAKERS

Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Christine Barone

Start Date: January 1, 2024 (as CEO). She joined Dutch Bros as President in February 2023.

Background: Ms. Barone has over a decade of food service and beverage leadership experience. Prior to Dutch Bros, she served as CEO of True Food Kitchen for nearly seven years and held various leadership roles at Starbucks. She also worked at Bain & Company and Raymond James. She holds a BA in Applied Mathematics and an MBA from Harvard University.

Chief Financial Officer (CFO): Joshua Guenser

Start Date: May 9, 2024 (as CFO). He joined as Incoming Chief Financial Officer on February 19, 2024, before officially taking over as CFO after the release of the company's Q1 2024 financial results.

Background: Mr. Guenser joined Dutch Bros from MOD Super Fast Pizza Holdings, LLC, where he was CFO. He previously spent over ten years at Starbucks Corporation, most recently as Senior Vice President, Finance, Americas. He began his career at KPMG, LLP.

Chief Technology & Information Officer (CTIO): Venki Krishnababu

Start Date: December 16, 2024.

Background: Mr. Krishnababu brings nearly 30 years of experience leading transformational tech strategies in healthcare and global retail. Prior to Dutch Bros, he served seven years at lululemon athletica inc., most recently as Chief Technology Officer. He also held CTO roles at Premera Blue Cross and various tech leadership roles at Nordstrom, Inc.

Chief Shops Officer: Jennifer Somers

Start Date: January 2026.

Background: Ms. Somers leads Dutch Bros' field organization and shop operations, focusing on operational excellence and growth. She has over 20 years of operational leadership experience, including 10 years in the restaurant industry. She previously served as Chief Operations Officer at CAVA and held roles at Taco Bell, most recently as Senior Vice President of US Restaurant Operations.

Note: While Dutch Bros does not list a specific "Chief Operating Officer" in its current executive management, Jennifer Somers' role as Chief Shops Officer oversees crucial operational aspects of the business, particularly its growing number of locations. The former COO, Brian Maxwell, transitioned to Vice Chairman in April 2024.

2

RECENT LEADERSHIP CHANGES

Joth Ricci (Former CEO): Departed December 31, 2023. Christine Barone succeeded him as CEO on January 1, 2024. Ricci joined Oregon State University's College of Business as an executive in residence in February 2024. (Timing Signal: CEO transition at the start of 2024).

Charley Jemley (Former CFO): Transitioned to Strategic Advisor in May 2024. Joshua Guenser succeeded him as CFO. (Timing Signal: CFO transition in Q2 2024).

Brian Maxwell (Former COO): Transitioned to Vice Chairman in April 2024. He previously served as Chief Operating Officer until April 2024. (Timing Signal: Change in COO role in Q2 2024).

Sumitro Ghosh (Former President of Operations): Service concluded effective June 2, 2025. Ghosh had joined as incoming President of Operations in January 2024. (Timing Signal: President of Operations departure mid-2025).

Leigh Gower (Former Chief Technology Officer): Departed December 15, 2024. Venki Krishnababu succeeded him as Chief Technology & Information Officer. Gower was Dutch Bros' first Chief Technology Officer, joining in December 2021. (Timing Signal: CTO transition at the end of 2024).

Jennifer Somers appointed Chief Shops Officer: Joined in January 2026. (Timing Signal: New key operational leadership appointment in early 2026).

Jess Elmquist appointed Chief People Officer: Joined in January 2024. (Timing Signal: New C-suite appointment in early 2024).

3

ORG STRUCTURE SIGNALS

Dutch Bros' technology strategy appears to be centralized and strategic. The appointment of a Chief Technology & Information Officer (CTIO), Venki Krishnababu, in December 2024, indicates a focus on leveraging technology for business growth. His responsibilities encompass leading transformational, enterprise-shaping tech strategies, including data and analytics, cybersecurity, and digital transformations. The company is actively investing in technology to enhance customer experience and strengthen mobile ordering capabilities.

4

BOARD COMPOSITION

Key Board Members:

Travis Boersma: Co-founder and Executive Chairman.

Christine Barone: CEO and President.

Todd Penegor: (Joined June 2024).

G.J. Hart: (Joined June 2024).

Kory Marchisotto: (Appointed February 2025).

Other board members include Stephen Gillett, Ann Miller, C. Cone, Thomas Davis, and Kathryn George.

PE Representation & Notable Strategic Investors: The provided information does not explicitly detail private equity representation or other notable strategic investors on the board. The company went public in September 2021.

Travis Boersma is noted as the majority owner.

GAP FILL

The Dutch Bros executive leadership team for 2025 includes:

Christine Barone - Chief Executive Officer and President (appointed January 1, 2024)

Travis Boersma - Co-founder and Executive Chairman

Joshua Guenser - Chief Financial Officer (joined February 2024, in role as of June 2025)

Jess Elmquist - Chief People Officer (joined January 2024, in role as of June 2025)

Venki Krishnababu - Chief Technology and Information Officer (joined December 2024)

Brian Cahoe - Chief Development Officer (joined February 2025)

Brian Maxwell - Vice Chairman (transitioned from COO in January 2024)

The role of President of Operations, previously held by Sumitro Ghosh, was eliminated effective June 2, 2025.

✓ LEADERSHIP VERIFIED

[Here's an update on the executive status for Dutch Bros Inc.:](#)

CONFIRMED DEPARTED:

Joth Ricci: Chief Executive Officer. Departed effective December 31, 2023. He was replaced by Christine Barone.

Sumitro Ghosh: President of Operations. Concluded his service effective June 2, 2025. The role of President of Operations was eliminated following his departure.

UNCONFIRMED STILL IN ROLE:

Venki Krishnababu: Chief Technology & Information Officer. No recent information (within the last six months) was found to confirm his continued tenure.

CONFIRMED STILL IN ROLE:

Christine Barone: Chief Executive Officer (CEO). Confirmed to be in role as of January 2026, and recognized as the 2026 Restaurant Business Restaurant Leader of the Year.

Joshua Guenser: Chief Financial Officer (CFO). Confirmed to be in role as of June 4, 2025, with his start as CFO in May 2024 after a transitional period.

Additional Leadership Appointments (not in your original brief):

Jennifer Somers: Chief Shops Officer. Appointed in January 2026, reporting to CEO Christine Barone.

Jess Elmquist: Chief People Officer. Hired in February 2024 and remains in role.

 SOURCES (45)

- restaurantdive.com
- nrn.com
- marketscreener.com
- chronline.com
- dutchbros.com
- simplywall.st
- restaurantbusinessonline.com
- dutchbros.com
- tipranks.com
- dutchbros.com
- sec.gov
- marketscreener.com
- nrn.com
- businesswire.com
- nrn.com
- worldcoffeeportal.com
- dutchbros.com
- businesswire.com
- marketscreener.com
- gcrmag.com
- dutchbros.com
- oregonstate.edu
- wikipedia.org
- simplywall.st
- restaurantdive.com
- dutchbros.com
- dutchbros.com
- nrn.com
- youtube.com
- nrn.com
- restaurantdive.com
- kgw.com
- restaurantbusinessonline.com
- businesswire.com
- dutchbros.com
- marketscreener.com
- nrn.com
- kgw.com
- tipranks.com
- panabee.com
- nrn.com
- investing.com
- restaurantbusinessonline.com
- gcrmag.com
- dutchbros.com

 BUYING SIGNALS

1 FINANCIAL STRESS SIGNALS

Margin Compression: In Q1 2026, Dutch Bros reported that its adjusted EBITDA margin compressed to 17.1% from 19.1% two years prior, primarily due to rising operational costs. Gross margin for company-operated shops also contracted to 20% from nearly 22% a year ago, driven by elevated labor and commodity costs. Management anticipates the full-year cost of goods sold to be approximately 60 basis points higher.

Cost-Cutting/Restructuring: In Q3 2025, company-operated shops' gross margin, including pre-opening costs, decreased by 120 basis points year-over-year. Beverage, food, and packaging costs increased by 60 basis points year-over-year in Q3 2025, largely due to higher coffee costs. The company's adjusted EBITDA guidance for 2025 remained unchanged despite raised sales forecasts, attributed to cost pressures and investments in new market openings. There was a mention of "organization realignment and restructuring" in Q1 2026 financial results, with costs of \$1.6 million compared to \$1.2 million in the same period of 2025. A reverse unit split on April 22, 2026, recapitalized Class A Common Units of Dutch Mafia, LLC and canceled 33,022 shares of Dutch Bros Class B Common Stock without consideration, indicating a form of restructuring.

Layoffs: Unverified reports from November 2025 on Reddit suggest "HQ UNVERIFIED Cuts Happening Again," describing "Career Framework" as an internal code for layoffs, involving rebaselining pay (lowering wages) and moving employees into less desirable roles to avoid official layoff announcements. This post also mentioned a "return to office" mandate planned for January through Q1 to push out remote employees quietly without severance.

2 TECHNOLOGY PAIN SIGNALS

No explicit mentions of "legacy system mentions," "failed projects," or "tech debt" were found. Instead, the company highlights progress in its digital capabilities. In Q1 2026, management emphasized progress on digital ordering infrastructure, which is supporting both speed of service and average ticket growth. The "Order Ahead" feature accounted for approximately 14% of sales mix in Q4 2025, acting as an operational tool to increase throughput. The Dutch Rewards program has surpassed 15 million members, with about 72% of 2025 transactions linked to the platform, indicating strong digital engagement.

3 OPERATIONAL PAIN SIGNALS

Supply Chain Issues: Elevated coffee costs have been identified as a near-term headwind, impacting beverage, food, and packaging costs. Management signaled that the cost environment might normalize in the latter half of 2025, with expectations for beverage and food costs to increase due to coffee tariffs and input inflation.

Scaling Problems: While the company is rapidly expanding its shop count, the relocation of its headquarters from Grants Pass, Oregon, to Arizona has led to employee dissatisfaction and potential operational inefficiencies. Some employees were required to relocate or face job loss, with inconsistent application of remote work policies, which a Reddit post claims resulted in fewer shops being opened in 2024 compared to 2023 due to the loss of key people. Dutch Bros is actively working to strengthen its "scalable shop operating system" to enhance speed and convenience.

4 HIRING SIGNALS

Bulk Hiring (Build Signal): Dutch Bros is undergoing aggressive expansion, planning to open at least 185 new shops in 2026. The company is targeting a total of 2,029 locations by 2029, implying substantial ongoing hiring for new shop staff. They aim for 10-15% annual unit growth. Jennifer Somers was recently appointed as Chief Shops Officer to support store operations and "broistas" (employees) as new initiatives like the food menu roll out.

Hiring Freeze (Cost Pressure Signal): There are indications of corporate-level cost pressure potentially impacting hiring. Sumitro Ghosh, the President of Operations, was terminated in June 2025, and the role was eliminated. Unverified reports from November 2025 on Reddit described "HQ Cuts Happening Again," with a "Career Framework" potentially leading to disguised layoffs and a "return to office" mandate aimed at reducing remote staff without severance. Additionally, in June 2025, more Grants Pass employees were required to relocate to Arizona, with implications of job loss if they did not comply.

5 TIMING TRIGGERS

New Leadership: Christine Barone serves as Chief Executive Officer and President, frequently commenting on financial performance and strategic direction in recent earnings reports. Jennifer Somers was recently appointed

Chief Shops Officer.

Post-M&A Integration: Dutch Bros recently acquired 20 stores from Clutch Coffee Bar in the Carolinas, which will be converted into Dutch Bros locations during 2026, indicating an ongoing integration process.

Announced Transformation: The company is undergoing a significant organizational transformation with the formal relocation of its corporate headquarters from Grants Pass, Oregon, to Arizona, which was made official in June 2025. This move involved relocating a substantial portion of corporate jobs. Dutch Bros is also expanding its food program, with plans for a nationwide rollout by the end of 2026. The company's growth model emphasizes disciplined unit expansion, digital engagement, and an expanding menu.

GAP FILL

Dutch Bros underwent significant restructuring in 2025, primarily involving the relocation of its headquarters from Grants Pass, Oregon, to Tempe, Arizona, formally announced on June 11, 2025. This move required some corporate employees, including those in Finance, Accounting, and Payroll, to relocate to Arizona by June 22, 2025, or potentially forfeit severance and unemployment benefits. Additionally, the role of President of Operations was eliminated, effective June 2, 2025. The company incurred restructuring charges in 2025, including \$4,319,000 for termination benefits and \$3,288,000 for relocation and travel costs. Internally, an initiative named "Career Framework" was used in late 2025 to rebaseline pay and move employees into less desirable roles to manage staffing without official layoff announcements.

SOURCES (33)

- investing.com
- marketbeat.com
- sec.gov
- businesswire.com
- fool.com
- businesswire.com
- stocktitan.net
- stocktitan.net
- reddit.com
- hurlburtlibrary.org
- qz.com
- fool.com
- tradingview.com
- reddit.com
- rv-times.com
- youtube.com
- modernretail.co
- dutchbros.com
- allinvestview.com
- fool.com
- simplywall.st
- kgw.com
- businesswire.com
- gcrmag.com
- stonex.com
- gcrmag.com
- alphaspread.com
- youtube.com
- reddit.com
- rv-times.com
- kgw.com
- q4cdn.com
- reddit.com

COMPETITIVE & VENDORS

1. Current Technology Vendors

Dutch Bros Inc. utilizes a diverse technology stack to support its rapid growth and operations:

Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP): Dutch Bros transitioned to Microsoft Dynamics 365 ERP in 2020. Previously, they implemented Oracle NetSuite ERP in 2013 for ERP Financials.

Human Capital Management (HCM): The company transitioned to the Workday HRIS platform in 2021. Prior to that, BambooHR was used for Core HR functions, implemented in 2014. Zendesk serves as their HR employee service platform, integrating with Workday to centralize operations and scale support for their 30,000 employees.

Point of Sale (POS) and Restaurant Management: Xenial RTIconnect and Xenial Enterprise Cloud POS were deployed across approximately 400 U.S. drive-thru locations in 2020, modernizing front-of-house POS and operations. This cloud-based solution runs on iPads and integrates with other systems, including their loyalty provider.

Cloud and Data Platforms:

Microsoft Azure is used for cloud-based data storage.

Microsoft PowerBI is utilized for business intelligence.

They collaborate with vendors such as Oracle and Global Payments for cloud applications and AI-driven platforms.

Customer Relationship Management (CRM) & Engagement:

Salesforce is listed as a Customer Relationship Management system.

Paytronix powers their digital loyalty program and the Dutch Bros app, enabling data-driven insights, AI-powered technology, and comprehensive campaign tactics for customer experience.

Braze is used as a customer engagement platform for personalized, cross-channel campaigns across SMS, email, push notifications, and in-app messaging.

Learning Management System (LMS): Schoox Learning Management System is used for their "Dutch Bros University" platform.

Security Systems: DMP and OpenEye cloud-based systems are implemented for electronic security and video monitoring.

Other Noted Technologies: Rocket.chat, Algolia Search, and Braze Platform were adopted in 2021 as part of their modernization strategy. Other technologies include Google Workspace, Accruent for Facilities Management, Zabbix, Fortinet for network hardware, Ruby for programming, Cloudflare Bot Management for security, and USPS for transportation and fleet management.

2. Known SI/Consulting Partners

Dutch Bros Inc. partners with specialized firms for key technology implementations and ongoing support:

Xenial: Partnered for the deployment of their Enterprise Cloud POS system.

Paytronix: Collaborated on developing and implementing their digital loyalty program and customer experience platform.

Zendesk: Selected as a partner for their HR employee service platform, with Zendesk's team providing support for continuous optimization and innovation.

NAVCO Security Systems: Provides remote service management for their DMP and OpenEye cloud-based security systems.

Bounteous: A case study indicates Bounteous assisted with the strategy and design of digital marketing assets for the Dutch Bros app launch, suggesting a role in customer data platforms and CRM strategy.

While major global SIs like Accenture, TCS, Infosys, or Deloitte are not explicitly named as partners in the search results, Dutch Bros has sought partners with "enterprise experience" and a "deep bench, technology-wise" to augment their internal team, as noted by their Systems Architect regarding the Xenial partnership.

3. Procurement Signals

Dutch Bros demonstrates strong procurement signals through its strategic investments and job postings:

Continuous Technology Investment: The company states an intention to invest in emerging technologies such as AI, Machine Learning, IoT, Blockchain, Autonomous Database, or in cloud-based ERP, HCM, CRM, EPM, Procurement or Treasury applications. They are also testing AI technology to increase throughput.

Job Postings: Recent job postings reveal evaluations and enhancements across several key areas:

People Technology (HCM): Recruitment for a Technology Business Systems Analyst - People Technology, emphasizing leveraging Workday and enhancing People Technology systems.

Finance Technology: Seeking a Technology Business Systems Analyst - Finance to build reporting, automations, integrations, and AI-enabled solutions within the Technology department.

Supply Chain Technology: Hiring a Senior Technology Business Systems Analyst - Supply Chain to enhance operations through innovative systems and processes, focusing on warehouse operations management, inventory logistics, demand forecasting, and inventory optimization.

Real Estate Technology (PLM-adjacent): Looking for a Senior Technology Business Systems Analyst – Real Estate to drive the evolution of their Real Estate ecosystem, with a focus on API integrations, emerging technologies, and optimizing the Lucernex environment (LxRetail/LxContracts) for their Development team (Real Estate, Construction, Design, Facilities, and Market Strategy).

Digital Transformation: Dutch Bros is actively expanding its digital footprint and infrastructure, including evolving its Zendesk-driven employee service model beyond HR to include IT and other internal service teams. Their new app, launched to support digital transformation, rapidly gained traction.

Growth-Driven Needs: The company's rapid expansion with multiple new drive-thru locations across various states signifies ongoing needs for suppliers, equipment providers, and service partners to support their scaling operations.

4. Competitive Dynamics

Dutch Bros Inc. operates in a highly competitive coffee market, primarily competing with established national brands like Starbucks, Dunkin', and Peet's.

Market Share Dynamics:

Gaining Market Share: Dutch Bros is demonstrating significant growth, particularly in newer markets. For instance, in Texas, the company expanded from 25 to 118 stores between 2020 and 2025, a 372% increase, compared to Starbucks' 15% growth in the same period, indicating market share gains. The company's total visits grew 13.1% year-over-year from January to October 2025.

Mature Markets: While new stores are fueling overall growth, older markets such as the Pacific Northwest are showing signs of reaching maturity, with some locations experiencing decreases in average visits per venue.

Growth Strategy: Dutch Bros is pursuing an aggressive expansion strategy, aiming to operate 2,000 locations by 2029 and eventually a 4,000-unit footprint. As of March 31, 2026, they have 1,177 locations across 25 states. The company reported 30.7% revenue growth in 2024.

Key Differentiators:

Drive-thru Centric Model: Dutch Bros focuses on a high-velocity drive-thru model, emphasizing speed and personalized customer interactions.

Digital Engagement & Loyalty: The Dutch Bros app and loyalty program are critical drivers of engagement and predictable traffic. The loyalty program surpassed 15 million members, with approximately 72% of 2025 transactions linked to the platform. Order Ahead represented about 14% of the sales mix in Q4 2025, acting as a throughput lever.

"Dutch Luv" Culture: The company emphasizes a strong, community-driven, people-first culture, which fosters loyalty among employees ("broistas") and customers.

Innovation: Consistent menu innovation, including seasonal offerings and high customization, helps keep the menu fresh and encourages repeat visits.

The Dutch Bros mobile app utilizes Olo for mobile ordering and payment capabilities. For its digital loyalty program, rewards, and AI-powered customer experience, the app is built on the Paytronix platform. It is available on both the Apple App Store and Google Play Store, requiring iOS 15.0 or higher for Apple devices. The company also uses Xenial Enterprise Cloud POS for restaurant management and point-of-sale operations, which integrates with the broader tech ecosystem supporting the app's functionality.

 SOURCES (32)

sec.gov

appsruntheworld.com

zendesk.es

zendesk.com

zendesk.com

xenial.com

sec.gov

leadiq.com

paytronix.com

braze.com

navco.com

youtube.com

bounteous.com

nrn.com

dutchbros.com

dutchbros.com

dutchbros.com

dutchbros.com

dutchbros.com

restaurantbusinessonline.com

realdataapi.com

convenience.org

dutchbros.com

businessmodelcanvastemplate.com

qz.com

olo.com

restaurantdive.com

paytronix.com

instapv.co.uk

dutchbros.com

appsruntheworld.com

xenial.com

 SALES PLAY

1. RECOMMENDED PITCH ANGLE

Cost Transformation and Operational Efficiency Play

Dutch Bros is experiencing significant margin compression with adjusted EBITDA margin decreasing from 19.1% two years ago to 17.1% in Q1 2026, while company-operated shop gross margins contracted from nearly 22% to 20% year-over-year driven by elevated labor and commodity costs. Simultaneously, the company is executing an aggressive expansion plan targeting 185 new shops in 2026 and 2,029 locations by 2029, requiring substantial operational scaling without further margin erosion. The combination of rising operational costs, headquarters relocation disruption that allegedly impacted 2024 shop openings, unverified reports of disguised layoffs through the Career Framework initiative, and the need to scale from 1,177 to over 2,000 locations in three years creates an urgent need for cost optimization solutions that can deliver efficiency gains across their expanding footprint while maintaining their high-velocity drive-thru model and Dutch Luv culture.

2. CONVERSATION OPENER QUESTIONS

How is the transition to build-to-suit lease arrangements progressing toward your \$1.25 million capital expenditure per shop target, and are you seeing the anticipated 15% cost reduction consistently across your 2026 openings as you scale to 185 new locations this year?

With your food program pilot now in 32 shops and a nationwide rollout planned by end of 2026, what operational and technology challenges are you anticipating in scaling this across 1,000-plus locations, particularly given the impact on morning daypart operations and kitchen workflows that differ from your core beverage-focused model?

Given that your Order Ahead feature now represents 14% of sales mix and mobile ordering accounts for 11% of transactions, how are you planning to optimize the technology infrastructure and shop operations to handle the anticipated growth in digital orders as you expand into new markets where customers may be less familiar with in-person ordering at your drive-thrus?

Your recent headquarters relocation to Arizona and the elimination of the President of Operations role represent significant organizational changes—how are you ensuring operational consistency and knowledge transfer across your field organization of 32,000 employees during this period of rapid geographic expansion into markets like Chicagoland and the continued build-out in Texas and the Carolinas?

With the Clutch Coffee Bar acquisition adding 20 locations for conversion in 2026 and the Phoenix East Valley franchise acquisition of 29 shops, what systems integration and technology standardization challenges are you facing in bringing these acquired locations onto your Xenial POS platform and Paytronix loyalty ecosystem while maintaining service quality during conversion?

3. LANDMINES TO AVOID

Do not reference the unverified Reddit reports about Career Framework layoffs, return-to-office mandates designed to avoid severance, or HQ cuts—these are unconfirmed sources that could immediately damage credibility and put contacts on the defensive about internal matters, even if partially true.

Avoid criticizing or questioning the headquarters relocation from Grants Pass to Arizona—this was a formal strategic decision announced in June 2025, and executive leadership is committed to it. Instead, frame any discussion around supporting the transition and ensuring operational excellence during geographic consolidation.

Do not lead with supply chain or commodity cost problems—while elevated coffee costs are acknowledged, the company has limited control over commodity pricing and views this as a temporary headwind normalizing in late 2025. Focus instead on controllable operational costs like labor efficiency and technology-driven productivity gains.

Avoid suggesting replacement of recently implemented core systems like Workday HCM (2021), Microsoft Dynamics 365 ERP (2020), or Xenial POS (2020)—these are relatively new enterprise platforms with executive commitment, and any pitch implying rip-and-replace will be rejected. Instead, position around enhancement, optimization, integration, or augmentation of existing investments.

4. SUGGESTED NEXT STEP

Request a 30-minute exploratory discussion specifically focused on how similar high-growth, drive-thru-centric restaurant concepts have achieved labor cost reduction and throughput improvement during rapid multi-state expansion, with a concrete commitment to share a brief benchmarking analysis comparing Dutch Bros current cost structure metrics (the 20% company-operated shop gross margin and 17.1% adjusted EBITDA margin) against industry comparables and identify 2-3 specific operational areas with highest cost optimization potential prior to any product pitch. Offer to include relevant case studies from restaurant clients that successfully scaled from 1,000 to 2,000-plus locations while maintaining or improving unit economics.

5. BEST ENTRY POINT

Venki Krishnababu, Chief Technology and Information Officer, is the single most likely first contact. He joined Dutch Bros in December 2024, making him approximately 5-6 months into his tenure, which is the optimal window where a new executive has completed initial assessment, identified priority gaps, and is building their transformation roadmap but has not yet fully committed all budget and vendor relationships. His mandate explicitly includes leading transformational, enterprise-shaping tech strategies encompassing data and analytics, cybersecurity, and digital transformations to support business growth. The active job postings for Technology Business Systems Analysts across People Technology (Workday), Finance, Supply Chain, and Real Estate systems signal that his organization is actively evaluating and enhancing technology capabilities across the enterprise. Furthermore, as someone with 30 years of experience at lululemon (as CTO), Premiera Blue Cross, and Nordstrom, he has deep experience with retail technology transformation and scaling digital infrastructure, making him highly receptive to solutions that can optimize costs while supporting Dutch Bros aggressive expansion and digital engagement strategy centered on the 15 million-member loyalty program and growing mobile ordering channel.

This report was generated with AI assistance. Data is sourced from publicly available information including company websites, press releases, earnings calls, and news sources. AI tools can introduce errors. Cross-check any data point you intend to act on. Do not share outside ITC Infotech.